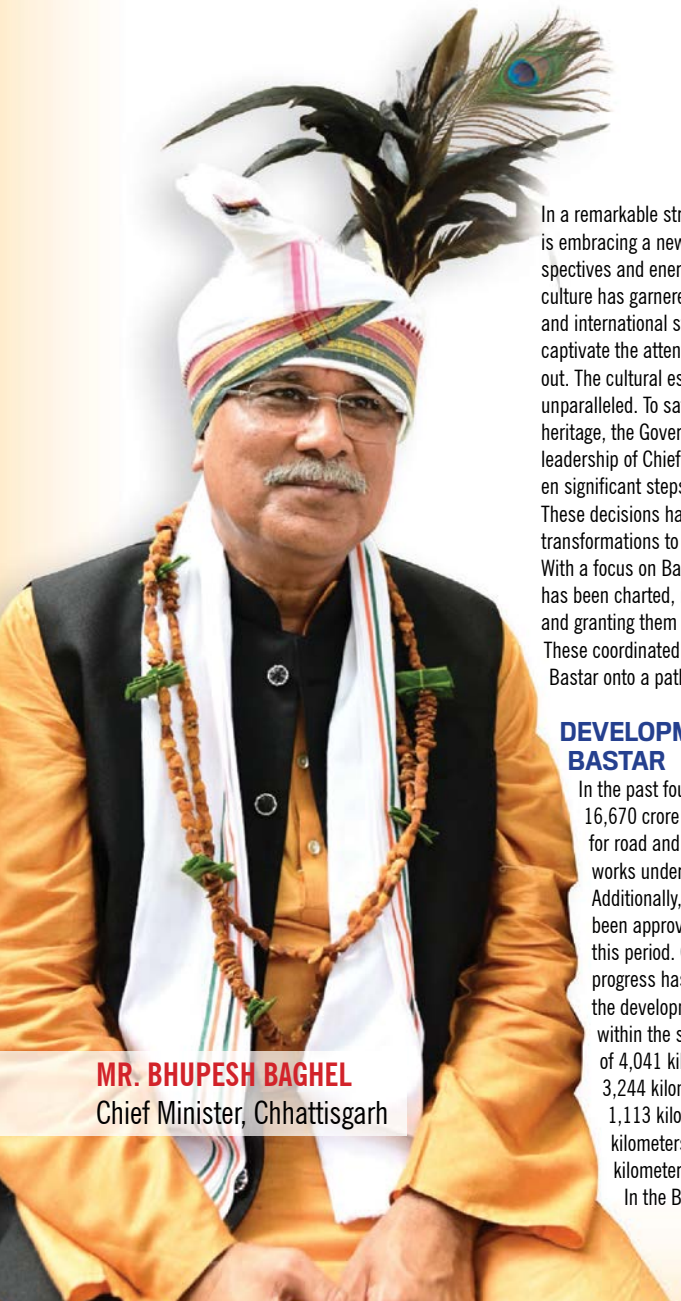
New Path of Development with New Thinking and Energy in Bastar



MR. BHUPESH BAGHEL
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> The tribal populations of Chhattisgarh stand as symbols of our ancient and rich cultural heritage. The state government's persistent efforts to uplift these indigenous communities through a range of schemes are yielding positive results, as evidenced by significant improvements in their quality of life. This, in turn, highlights the state's remarkable progress.
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> **Bhupesh Baghel**
> Chief Minister, Chhattisgarh

In a remarkable stride towards development, Bastar is embracing a new trajectory infused with fresh perspectives and energy. The region's unique indigenous culture has garnered recognition on both the national and international stage. Its exceptional traditions captivate the attention of people, making Bastar stand out. The cultural essence here is truly distinct and unparalleled. To safeguard and nurture this indigenous heritage, the Government of Chhattisgarh, under the leadership of Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel, has taken significant steps in the past four and a half years. These decisions have brought substantial positive transformations to the lives of the tribal population. With a focus on Bastar's progress, a novel roadmap has been charted, redefining the roles of its people and granting them just rights over their resources. These coordinated efforts have borne fruit, propelling Bastar onto a path of prosperity and development.

DEVELOPMENT PATHWAYS IN BASTAR

In the past four and a half years, approximately 16,670 crore rupees have been allocated for road and bridge projects, totaling 7,406 works under various schemes in the state. Additionally, around 908 crore rupees have been approved for 419 building projects during this period. Over the last four years, significant progress has been made in Chhattisgarh, with the development of 9,884 kilometers of roads within the state. This includes the construction of 4,041 kilometers of new asphalt roads, 3,244 kilometers of upgraded asphalt roads, 1,113 kilometers of widened roads, 588 kilometers of strengthened roads, and 898 kilometers of cement-concretized roads.

In the Bastar region, the Narayanpur-Pali-Barsur road route has been fully completed. This newly constructed route has significantly reduced the distance between the two districts, as it cuts through mountains and provides paved roads. This development has eradicated the dominance of Naxal groups and transformed the lives of rural communities, bringing essential services like healthcare and education to the forefront. Infrastructure projects are underway, including the construction of bridges and culverts, at an estimated cost of 1244 lakh rupees for the Tikeripadar-Tiriya (Jagdalpur), Barda-Belputi (Bakawand), Ganupar-Jatnapal-Gutiguda Para (Bastar) road route. Furthermore, in the Bastar district, a 26-kilometer-long road stretch, the Bakawand-Kolaval road, has been built at a cost of 21.44 crore rupees, and a 19.29-kilometer-long Jagdalpur bypass road is being reconstructed with an investment of approximately 41 crore rupees.

With an investment of 16,670 crore rupees, the development of roads is progressing in the region. The Bastar division, encompassing challenging areas like Sukma, Bijapur, Narayanpur, Dantewada, and Bastar, is witnessing transformative changes. Over the past four and a half years, around 2,500 kilometers of roads have been constructed in Bastar. Moreover, nearly 36 new bridges, including two over the Indravati River, have been erected.

OVER 600 VILLAGES LIBERATED FROM MAOIST MENACE IN BASTAR REGION

In a significant turn of events, the impact of special campaigns against Maoists is now becoming evident across the seven districts of the Bastar region. In the last two years alone, more than 500 Maoists have surrendered in Dantewada district. Even Sukma, the district most affected by Naxal insurgency, has made